Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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Additional Forms of Employment

The information on this page is based on current immigration regulations and USC policies, and may not apply to non-USC international students.

Jump to a Section

Name, Image and Likeness (NIL)

In 2021, many states passed laws regarding compensation for using a student-athlete's name, image and likeness (NIL). The U.S. Department of Homeland Security (DHS) has not taken a position on whether compensated NIL arrangements constitute e l the DHS adopts a position, OIS recommends that inte

- Always contact OIS for information abou a status.
- Refrain from participating in any NIL act ditional guidance.

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International students in F-1 or J-1 status who are interested in entrepreneurship, startups or self-employment must ensure they have the appropriate employment authorization before engaging in any business activity.

Working for a startup and starting your own business are not the same from an immigration perspective. Students may only engage in entrepreneurial activities that are permitted under their immigration status and authorized employment benefit.

Students who establish a business may also be subject to U.S. tax and business registration requirements and should consult a qualified tax professional or attorney as appropriate.

F-1 Students

J-1 Students

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